

Hz Umer Farooq ^{RA}

Umer

ibn al-Khattab (1)

ibn Nufayl (2)

ibn Abd-ul-Uzza (3)

ibn Riyal (4)

ibn Abdillah (5)

ibn Qurt (6)

ibn Razah (7)

ibn Adi (8)

ibn Ka'b

ibn Luayy

ibn Ghalib

Tribe

- Meets the prophet ^{SAW} in 8 generations
- From the clan **Bano Adi** (Not among the top clans of the Quraysh)
- Nufayl was the leader of the Quraysh of his time
- **Zayd bin Amr bin Nufayl** (one of the 4 Hunafa) was his cousin

Family

- His father **Al-Khattaab**
 - Was a very harsh and bitter man
 - Hardly any mention of him in the history books
 - Most likely died before the coming of Islam
- His mother **is Hantamah bint Hisham** (Bano Makhzum)
 - First cousin of Abu Jahal
 - Khalid bin Walid ^{RA} also from her clan

AGE

Born 13 years
after the
Prophet ^{SAW}

CHILDHOOD

Hard childhood when he used to
be a shepherd and his father used
to sometimes beat him and he
hardly earned anything

PROFESSION

Caravan Manager
turned trader
Did well for himself
but not rich

KNOWLEDGE

One of the very
few Sahaba who
knew how to read
and write

STATUS

Ambassador of the
Quraysh to settle
disputes and negotiate
with other tribes.

So he gets a flavour of
politics with this role

CHARACTER

- Very Sincere and loyal
- Uncompromising, Firm
- He himself mentions that during Jahiliyyah He used to drink
whine and had bad company
- The story of him burying his daughter is fabricated, not found
in any early books. Even his Kuniah is Abu Hafs.
- He said that he had no desire for women other than that he
wanted to have children

7 wives, over 13 children

- 1st Wife - **Zaynab bint Maz'un**
 - Hz Hafsa ^{RA} (His first born)
 - Hz Abdullah Ibn Umer
- Last wife - **Umme Qulthoom bint Abi Talib**
(The daughter of Hz Ali ^{RA} and Hz Fatima ^{RA})
 - Zayd ibn Umar
 - Ruqayyah bint Umar
- Hz Umer ^{RA} proposed to the daughter of Hz Abu Bakar ^{RA} Hz Asma while he was the caliph and she turned him down saying his lifestyle if too frugal

Physical Description

- Light skinned with a reddish tone
- Deep Eyes, Large hands and feet
- Taller than the average Qurash
- Strong muscular body
- Thick beard, died with Henna
- Large Mustache which he used to twirl

Acceptance Of Islam

- His brother (Hz Zayd) and sister (Fatima) embraced Islam before him
- He had not killed a muslim before conversion
- 6th year of Dawah, 3rd year after Islam goes public so he was persecuted for 2.5 years
- 3 days after the conversion of Hz Hamza ^{RA}
- He was in his early 30s
- Prophet ^{SAW}: Bless Islam with either Abu Jahal or Umer whoever is more beloved to you
- Two stories of conversion
 - He heard Prophet ^{SAW} pray at night in front of Kaaba and converted there
 - Was going to kill the prophet ^{SAW}, met Nu'aim bin Abdillah who mentioned of the conversion of his brother in law Saeed ibn Zayd (One of the Ashra Mubashra) and his sister Fatima-> hit her -> felt bad -> was told to do Ghusl -> Read Surah Taha -> Went to Dar-ul-Arkam and converted -> All went to Kaba to offer Salah
- Ibne Masud said, The conversion of Umer marked for us the beginning of Izzah.
- Ibne Masud said, we could not pray in front of Kaba before Umer's conversion
- The only person who did not emigrate secretly, in fact announced before going

His Role before Khilafat

- Participated in all major battles after Hijrah (Badr, Uhud, Khandaq, etc.).
- Known for bold counsel, several Qur'anic revelations agreed with his opinions
- Trusted senior advisor to the Prophet ^{SAW} political and military matters.
- Played a stabilizing role after the Prophet's ^{SAW} passing by supporting Abu Bakr (RA) at Saqifah.
- Initially differed on fighting the Zakat rejectors, then became Abu Bakr's strongest backer in the Ridda wars.
- Served as chief advisor in political, military, and administrative matters.
- Supported the decision to send Usama ibn Zayd's army despite Madinah's vulnerability.
- Urged compilation of the Qur'an after heavy losses of Huffaz at Yamamah.
- Acted as Abu Bakr's closest confidant and stabilizing force in governance.

View of Hz Umer RA with subsequent confirmatory revelations of Qur'an

The Station of Ibrahim (Maqam Ibrahim) as a Place of Prayer

Hz. Umar (RA) suggested that the Maqam Ibrahim should be designated as a place of prayer. Shortly after, the ayah was revealed

The Hijab

"And when you ask his wives for something, ask them from behind a curtain." (Al-Ahzab: 53)

The Prohibition of Alcohol (Khamr)

Hz. Umar (RA) made du'a saying: "O Allah, give us a clear ruling on khamr." The progressive revelations on the prohibition of alcohol came, culminating in the decisive verse:

The Prisoners of Badr

Not Praying Over The Dead of Munafiqoon

When Abdullah ibn Ubayy ibn Salul, the chief hypocrite, died, the Prophet ﷺ intended to pray his janazah. Hz. Umar (RA) strongly objected. The revelation came confirming his position

Conquests

- Unprecedented and un-expected expansion in the human history
- Roman and Persians were both very old civilizations, who had mastered the art of war strategies and had been at war with each other for hundreds of years
- Arabs were un-educated, un-trained in the arts of war, had no generational knowledge of organized war crafts
- Romans and Persians didn't even bother conquering the Arab lands / tribes, that's how un-important Arabs were to them
- What we see happening with regards to the conquests of Muslims in this period sounds like fairy tales

End of Hz Abu Bakar's Caliphate – 634CE

- Muslims had won the battle of Ajnadayn
- Heraclius went back to safety in the city of Antioch to regroup and launch a massive attack
- Muslims had laid siege to Damascus
- During the siege Hz Abu Bakar RA died
- Since almost half the army had gone from Iraq to Syria to fight under Hz Khalid bin Walid, the khusro of Persia mobilized a huge army to take back the lost cities.
- Hz Muthana bin Harith RA gave the charge in Persia to someone else and rushed to Medina to ask for Reinforcements
- Hz Abu Bakar on his death bed told Hz Umer RA that he needs to send reinforcements to Iraq

Start of Hz Umer RA's Caliphate – 634 CE

- Message is sent to Hz Khalid bin Walid RA that the new leader of the army is Hz Abu Ubaydah bin Jarrah RA
 - Western historians write many reasons for this, which show animosity between the two for personal reasons
 - Actual reason could be that Muslims should not start attributing the success to one person only and should attribute it to Allah swt.
 - He did not want Hz Khalid RA to become pompous
 - He did not agree with some of his decisions.
 - On some occasions he acted as if he had a free hand to take decisions without caliph's approval, example: going for Hajj during conquests
 - The killing of Malik bin Nuwairah
 - Hz Umer RA always thought good of Hz Khalid bin Walid till his death and considered him Saif-Ullah

Fall of Damascus

- After a few months of the siege, the city of Damascus fell
- Hz Umer Appointed Yazid bin Abu Sufyan RA as the governor, who was later replaced by Hz Abu Muawiya RA
- Hz Umer had a policy that Muslims should not live in the conquered cities with the people who have been conquered. They should make a new garrison city outside the main city.
- Wisdom behind this
 - He didn't want Muslims to be complacent and stop conquering more lands
 - Retain the purity of faith, and not be corrupted by others
 - So that the conquered don't feel the presence of the conqueror all the time
 - Most of the those garrison cities later became bigger than the original cities, e.g Kufa, Basra, Cairo etc
 - However, it didn't work for Damascus and the original city remained the main city

Battle Yarmouk

- Write here

Fall of Jerusalem

- Laid siege to Jerusalem for 4 months
- After 4 months the bishop Sephronius accepted to surrender on the condition that the caliph himself comes to take the keys of the city
- Hz Umer^{RA} goes to the city taking turns on the camel with his servant
- Hz Umer^{RA} signs the treaty of Jerusalem
 - The Christians are given rights to practice but not to preach or ring church bells
 - They are not to be forced into Islam
- At the time of Zohar Hz Umer^{RA} was given the choice to pray in the church but he refused thinking that where I pray they may later make a mosque and I don't want this church be taken down. He prayed outside, in front of the church and there is mosque there today.
- The keys of the church were given to Hz Umer^{RA} for safekeeping and to this day they're with a Muslim family.

The Plague of Amwas

- Named after the town of Amwas, in 16 AH, 637 CE
- Killed an estimated 25,000 Sahabah and Muslims, including some of the greatest commanders and scholars of the time (HZ Abu Ubayda ^{RA}, Hz Mu'az ibn Jabal ^{RA}, Hz Yazid ibn Abi Sufyan^{RA}, and Hz Shurahbil ibn Hasana ^{RA})
- Hz Umer ^{RA} set out from Madinah to visit the armies of Shaam. When he reached Sargh, he received news of the plague spreading.
- He did mashwara with other Sahaba whether to enter the city or return. There was a difference of opinion and he finally decided to turn back. Hz Abu Ubayda's ^{RA} said: "Are you fleeing from the qadar of Allah?" to which Hz Umer replied "Yes, we flee from the qadar of Allah to the qadar of Allah" and cited the example of a man who moves his camels from barren land to fertile land, both are by qadar.
- Hz Umar ^{RA} then received confirmation from Hz Abd al-Rahman ibn Awf^{RA} of the hadith: "If you hear of plague in a land, do not enter it. If it breaks out while you are in it, do not leave." This settled the matter.
- After Abu Ubayda ^{RA} passed, command passed to Hz Amr ibn al-As ^{RA} who ordered the army to disperse into the hills, reasoning that the plague spread in crowded, low-lying areas

Conquest of Egypt

- In 18 AH, 639 AD. Hz Amr Ibn al-As^{RA} asks Hz Umer^{RA} for permission to invade Egypt
- Hz Umer^{RA} agrees and lets him go to Egypt. But when Hz Amr is on his way Hz Umer changed his mind and sent a letter to Hz Amr RA to come back if you haven't entered the city since we need you for sassinids. Hz Amr^{RA} had a hunch what the letter was going to say, so he opened the letter after entering the city.
- Egypt was the intellectual capital of Christianity, especially Alaxandria
- Cyrus of Alexandria (Al-Muqawqis), was both the governor of Egypt and the head of the church there. Same governor who had sent presents to the Prophet^{SAW}
- Muqawqis was a melkite Christian and a foreigner trying to convert the locals to his sect who were Coptic Christians. So there was dissent in the public. Maqawqis also had differences with the Byzantines with regards to Christian beliefs. So the timing was ideal for a takeover.
- Babylon was put under a 7 month siege. Muqawqis wanted to surrender and pay Jizya but Theodore didn't let him, so the city of Babylon (present day Cairo) was conquered by scaling the walls and opening the gates. It took only 4,000 Muslims to do so with no bloodshed.
- Hz Amr^{RA} demands more troops and is given around 4,000-6,000 more, making the army 10,000

Conquest of Egypt

- Forces march towards Alaxandria (One of the biggest fortresses of that time, biggest library). Byzantine sends many troops to challenge Muslim army and stop them on the way but Muslims lay siege to the city.
- Alaxandria had many layers of fortified walls which different empires had built over time, it had catapults and it had access to sea with roman supplies coming in. 100s of Muslims died during this siege.
- Theodore the Byzantine king, decided to go himself to the city with an army to defend it, but just as he left with the navy he died, which led to chaos in the empire and abandonment of Alaxandria's defense campiagn. The city surrendered.
- Hz Amr ^{RA} wanted to make Alaxandria the capital, but Hz Umer ^{RA} did not accept. It was a coastal city which could be attacked from the sea and Muslims didn't have a navy.
- Hz Amr ^{RA} started another city with the name of Fustat just outside Babylon. Fustat later expanded and engulfed Babylon. Under Fatimids a new city name Cahira outside Fustat was built. This city later expanded and engulfed Fustat and is the present day Cairo.
- Hz Amr ^{RA} proposed that why don't we connect the mediterranean sea with the Red sea. Hz Umer RA didn't accept the idea since it would've byzantine empire direct access to Makkah.

Fall of the Sassinids

- Predictions about the fall of Sassinids and Romans

- At the time of Khandaq while hitting the rock with axe
- The Promise to Suraqah bin Malik during Hijrah

During the time of Hz Abu Bakar ^{RA}

- Since almost half the army had gone from Iraq to Syria to fight under Hz Khalid bin Walid, the khusro of Persia mobilized a huge army to take back the lost cities.
- Persians take most the land back while Hz Khalid bin Walid is in Syria
- Hz Muthana bin Harith ^{RA} gave the charge in Persia to someone else and rushed to Medina to ask for Reinforcements
- Hz Abu Bakar on his death bed told Hz Umer ^{RA} that he needs to send reinforcements to Iraq

The Rest of battles

- Battle of the Bridge (al-Jisr)
- Battle of Buwaib
- Battle of al-Qadisiyyah
- Capture of al-Madain (Ctesiphon)
- Battle of Jalula
- Conquest of Tikrit & Mosul region

Hz Umer RA's administration and leadership

- **The scale of what he governed.** In just 10 years, the caliphate expanded to cover Persia, Iraq, Syria, Palestine, Egypt, and parts of North Africa, yet remained administratively coherent. He was governing millions of people across three continents with no telecommunications, no printing press, and no bureaucratic tradition to inherit.
- **He built the state from scratch.** There was no Islamic state before him in the full institutional sense. The Diwan, the provincial governorship system, the independent judiciary, the fiscal framework, the military rotation policy, he invented these. He wasn't reforming existing institutions. He was creating them.
- **He held power without being corrupted by it.** He lived on a stipend he set for himself at the level of an average man. He patched his own clothes. He slept under a tree while traveling. The treasury of Persia passed through his hands and he took none of it personally. This is almost unparalleled in the history of any empire.
- **He was feared and loved in equal measure.** Governors, generals, and commanders who had conquered nations were afraid to face him over a single complaint from a commoner. Yet the ordinary people, the Bedouin, the widow, the hungry family, ran to him. Power flowed downward in his caliphate, not upward.
- **He held himself to a higher standard than everyone else.** He punished his own son. He corrected himself publicly. He asked to be corrected with swords if he went astray. No leader in his position, in any civilization of that era, operated with that level of self-imposed accountability.

Hz Umer RA's initiatives

1- Shura

- Hz. Umar RA institutionalized consultation as a **structural practice**, not just an occasional courtesy.
- Maintained a council of senior companions, both the **Muhajireen and the Ansar**, whom he consulted on major decisions.
- He is famously reported to have said: *"There is no caliphate without consultation."*
- His shura operated at multiple levels. For major state decisions (military campaigns, policy changes), he convened a broad assembly. For jurisprudential questions, he consulted the senior fuqaha.
- The youngsters were also included to give them exposure and training to become future leaders
- For local matters, he empowered governors but held them accountable through public hearings.
- Even on the matter of appointing the next caliph, he appointed a committee of six (the *Shura al-Sitta*) to choose his successor rather than appointing anyone himself.

2. Night Patrols

- This was unheard of, he could've appointed an employee for this, but he always went himself
- Often alone or with one companion (usually Aslam, his freed slave), to personally check on the condition of his people. This was a regular practice.
- **The soldier's wife and the four-month policy.** One of the most moving incidents: during a night patrol, Hz. Umar RA passed by a tent and heard a woman reciting poetry about her longing for her husband who was away at war. He realized this was a widespread problem, soldiers were being deployed for too long without return. He asked Hafsa ^{RA}: *"How long can a woman bear separation from her husband?"* She said four months. He then issued a policy that soldiers would not be kept away from their families for more than four months at a stretch, and must be rotated back.
- **The woman and the hungry children.** On another night, he found a woman cooking a pot over a fire with her children crying from hunger. She was boiling stones to calm them. He went personally to the Bayt al-Mal, carried a sack of food on his own back (his companion offered, but he refused, saying he would carry his own burden on the Day of Judgment), and cooked for the family himself. He did not reveal who he was until he left.

3. Equal Treatment and Justice

- Hz. Umar RA applied the law without regard for status, lineage, or proximity to power.
- **His own son and the wine.** His son Abu Shahma was found drinking wine in Egypt. He confessed and wanted to be punished as per the law. Hz Amr^{RA} lashed him in his own house and his head was shaved. When the news reached Hz Umer^{RA} he was furious at Hz Amr^{RA} that he had given concession to Abu Shahma and not lashed him in public. Hz. Umar^{RA} had him brought to Madinah and administered the hadd punishment personally, publicly, before an audience. Abu Shahma died not long after.
- **His own rights defined.** Hz. Umar^{RA} famously set his own entitlement from the Bayt al-Mal at the level of a man of moderate means from the Quraysh, specifically: one ride (a camel), one set of winter clothing, one set of summer clothing, food to sustain his family at an average level, and no more. He accepted no private gifts, no special provisions.
- **The Copt and Amr's son.** A similar and famous incident involves Amr ibn al-As's own son, who had beaten a Coptic man after he won in a horse race and then struck him with a whip. When the Copt appealed to Hz. Umar RA at Hajj, Hz. Umar RA gave him the whip and told him to strike the governor's son in retaliation. He then famously said: "**O Amr, since when have you enslaved the people when their mothers gave birth to them as free men?**"

3. Equal Treatment and Justice

- **Governor of Hims makes a second floor room.** Hz Umer RA asked a passer by from Hims about the governor there. The person replied he is the best of governors, however he's made a second floor room for himself. Hz Umer RA sent a messenger tasked to burn down the door of the governor's house and have him come to medine. On return to media the Governor Ibne Qart is imprisoned in sun for three days then asked to water the camels. Hz Umar ^{RA} said: "Is that why he have built yourself a second-floor room, out of which to look down on Muslims, widows, orphans... etc.? Go back to your work and do not give me a cause to send for you again."
- **Accountability for a Drowned Man:** A governor forced an elderly man into cold water to gauge its depth, and the man drowned crying 'Umar's name. 'Umar summoned the governor and refused to speak to him for days out of anger. When the governor justified it with the conquests and booty gained, 'Umar rejected the excuse entirely. He declared one Muslim life worth more than all the spoils, ordered bloodmoney to be paid, and banished the governor from his sight.

4. The Three Tiers of Authority

- **Caliph:** The supreme head in Madinah. All authority ultimately traced back to him. Governors were appointed, monitored, and removed by him. He set policy, received complaints against governors, and conducted audits.
- **Majlis-e-Shura:** Consultative body divided into Majlis-e-Aam (general citizens) and Majlis-e-Khas (leading Sahaba) for policy decisions.
- **Governor (Amir):** Appointed by the Caliph over a large province like Egypt, Syria, Iraq, or Persia. He held overall executive and military authority for the province. Examples: Hz Amr ibn al-As^{RA} over Egypt, Hz Sa'd ibn Abi Waqqas^{RA} over Kufa, Hz Abu Musa al-Ashari^{RA} over Basra.
- **Wali:** A sub-governor appointed over a smaller district or city within the province, reporting to the Governor. So within Egypt, the Governor sat in Fustat, but individual cities like Alexandria or Barqa would have their own Wali managing local affairs.
- **The Six Officials Under the Wali:** (All these were independently accountable)
 - **1. Katib: The Secretary** The administrative secretary of the Wali
 - **2. Katib ud Diwan:** The Diwan Administrator
 - **3. Sahib ul Kharaj:** The Revenue Collector
 - **4. Sahib ul Ahdath:** The Chief of Police
 - **5. Sahib Bait ul Mal:** The Treasury Officer
 - **6. Qadi:** The Judge

5. Communal Land

- Refused to distribute conquered agricultural land of Iraq, Syria, and Egypt to soldiers despite established precedent and strong pressure from companions including Hz Bilal ^{RA}
- Declared conquered lands communal Muslim property, owned by the entire ummah present and future
- Present generation had no right to consume the entire wealth of the ummah
- Cited Surah al-Hashr 59:10, the rights of those who came after
- Existing farmers kept their land and paid kharaj annually instead

The Iraq Land Survey

- Sent Uthman ibn Hunaif ^{RA} to survey the entire Sawad
- Assessed soil quality, water access, crop type, and yield history
- Set differentiated kharaj rates by crop, wheat, barley, dates, vineyards
- Total assessed revenue: 80–100 million dirhams annually

5. Communal Land

- **Other Resource Distribution Principles**
- Water sources declared communal, no private monopolization of rivers or springs
- Mineral deposits declared state property, khums paid to Bayt al-Mal
- Forests and open grazing lands kept communal, no tribal fencing off

6. The Diwan Registry

This was one of Hz. Umar ^{RA's} most important administrative innovations. When vast wealth began flowing into the Bayt al-Mal from conquered territories, the question of how to distribute it arose. Hz. Umar ^{RA} established the Diwan, a state registry that enrolled all Muslims, with their stipends.

- **Structure.** The registry was organized by order of proximity to Islam:
 1. Closest relatives of the Prophet (PBUH).
 2. Early converts and veterans of key battles (Badr, Uhud, etc.).
 3. Later converts and those with other contributions.
 4. Even new converts and non-combatants, including women and children, received shares, ensuring a basic level of social security. This acknowledged precedence while ensuring broad distribution.

Beyond stipends, the Diwan functioned as a comprehensive demographic record of the caliphate. It tracked:

- Names and tribal affiliations of all Muslim men
- Their military service history and battles participated in
- Dependents and family members entitled to welfare
- Non-Muslim subjects and their tax obligations
- The assets and declared wealth of governors upon appointment (for accountability purposes)

7. Economic Policy

Hz. Umar RA developed a sophisticated fiscal framework that became the template for Islamic state finance.

- **Jizya.** He standardized the jizya at **differentiated rates based on wealth**. He also made a crucial ruling that it must never be collected through coercion or humiliation, and he **removed it entirely from the elderly, the sick, and those unable to work.**
- **Kharaj (land tax).** Rather than distributing conquered agricultural land from Persia and the Levant to individual soldiers (as was the custom), Hz. Umar ^{RA} made the revolutionary decision to leave it in the hands of the existing farmers, who would pay a land tax (kharaj) to the Muslim treasury. This ensured long-term revenue stability and prevented the creation of a landowner class from among the conquerors.
- **Ushoor (trade tariff).** He instituted the ushoor, a tax on trade passing through Muslim territories. He applied it at the reciprocal rate: if a foreign state taxed Muslim merchants at 5%, he taxed their merchants at 5%. If 10%, then 10%.

7. Economic Policy

Zakat

- **Centralized collection.** It was collected by state officials (amilis) appointed specifically for this purpose, brought to the Bayt al-Mal, and then distributed through the Diwan system. This prevented both underpayment and misdistribution.
- **Masarif al-Zakat:** Hz. Umar ^{RA} was rigorous about ensuring zakat reached all eight categories mentioned in the Quran (Surah al-Tawbah 9:60), the poor, the destitute, zakat collectors, those whose hearts were to be reconciled, slaves to be freed, debtors, those in the way of Allah, and the stranded travelers. He audited distributions and held amils accountable for reaching all categories.
- **The Muallafat al-Quloob controversy.** One of his most famous and debated fiscal decisions involved the eighth category, those *whose hearts were to be reconciled* (muallafat al-quloob). During the Prophet's ^{SAW} time, certain tribal leaders were given zakat funds as political inducements to keep them allied with Islam. Hz. Umar ^{RA} discontinued this practice, arguing that Islam was now strong enough that it did not need to purchase loyalty. When challenged, because this appeared to contradict explicit Quranic text, he responded that the ruling applied when Islam was weak; now that Islam was dominant, the rationale had changed. This became a landmark case in the fiqh of maslaha and changing rulings with changing circumstances.

8. Sending Companions to Educate the Provinces

- As the caliphate expanded rapidly, Hz. Umar RA was acutely aware of the danger of new Muslims, and even new territories, being cut off from authentic Islamic knowledge.
- He systematically deployed companions to different regions as teachers and scholars:
 - **Hz. Ibn Masood RA** was sent to Kufa. He became the foundation of the entire Iraqi scholarly tradition.
 - **Hz. Muadh ibn Jabal RA** - Syria.
 - **Hz. Abu Darda RA** - Damascus.
 - **Hz. Ubada ibn al-Samit RA** - Palestine.
- He would also write letters to governors explaining the fiqh rulings they needed to implement, sometimes issuing written opinions that constitute the earliest corpus of administrative Islamic jurisprudence.

9. Standardizing Congregational Tarawih

In the early years of Islam, people prayed Tarawih individually or in small scattered groups during Ramadan. Hz. Umar ^{RA} passed by the masjid one Ramadan night and saw people praying in scattered clusters. He gathered them behind a single imam Hz Ubayy ibn Ka'b ^{RA} and said: "What an excellent bid'ah this is!"

10. Suspending Harsh Punishments During Hardship

During the famine (18 AH), Hz. Umar ^{RA} suspended the hadd punishment for theft. His reasoning was that when people are stealing out of genuine hunger and desperation, when normal conditions for applying the law no longer exist, the punishment cannot be justly applied.

11. Emergency Relief and Public Health Measures

During the famine, Hz. Umar RA organized what was effectively a state-level emergency operation: he wrote to the governor of Egypt (Amr ibn al-As RA) requesting grain shipments. The caravans that came were so large that Hz. Umar RA reportedly said the camels looked like a river from a distance.

12. Judicial System

Hz. Umar RA separated the judicial function from the executive function. Rather than having governors adjudicate all disputes, he appointed independent qadis (judges) for different regions. This was a foundational move in the development of an independent judiciary in Islamic governance.

13. Governor Accountability

Hz. Umar RA held his governors to an extraordinary standard. He would require them to declare their assets upon appointment and would compare their assets after a term, any unexplained increase was confiscated. He personally investigated complaints about governors and did not shield them on account of their status or companionship.

14. The Hijri Calendar

The need arose when administrative documents from different provinces were arriving undated or inconsistently dated. He convened a shura to decide the starting point. The companions debated various anchors, the birth of the Prophet ^{SAW} the beginning of revelation, the year of the migration. Hz. Umar ^{RA} chose the Hijra, as it was the moment that marked the transformation of the Muslim community from a persecuted group to a functioning society. The year was set retroactively from 1 AH (622 CE), and the first month as Muharram.

15. Military Initiatives

Professional Standing Army

- Created the first professional salaried Muslim army, soldiers received fixed annual ata (stipend) regardless of whether actively fighting
- Ended the pre-Islamic model of fighters compensated only through war spoils
- Families of soldiers received rizq (monthly rations) while husbands were on campaign

Military Rotation Policy

- Introduced the four-month rotation rule, soldiers could not be kept away from families beyond four months

Garrison Cities

- Founded dedicated military garrison cities rather than integrating soldiers into existing civilian populations
- Kufa and Basra in Iraq, Fustat in Egypt, Jabiya in Syria
- These cities kept the army organized, disciplined, and rapidly deployable

15. Military Initiatives

Separation of Military and Civil Authority

- Governors held overall command but Hz. Umar ^{RA} appointed independent qadis, treasury officers, and Diwan administrators in every province
- Military commanders were not given unchecked civil power, preventing the rise of warlords

Commander Accountability

- Required commanders to declare assets before and after appointment
- Personally investigated complaints against military leadership regardless of their status or companionship

Intelligence and Strategic Communication

- Maintained a network of messengers between Madinah and all fronts, he was kept informed of battlefield developments in near real-time for that era

Challenges

Military Expansion and Governance Challenges

Social and Economic Inequality

Religious and Theological Issues and the Preservation of Orthodoxy

Hz Umer RA's Leadership

Hz Umer RA's initiatives



Death of Hz Umer ^{RA}

- The Prophet ^{SAW} once climbed the mountain of Uhud together with Hz Abu Bakr ^{RA}, Hz Umar ^{RA}, and Hz Uthmaan ^{RA}. The mountain began to shake beneath their feet. The Prophet ^{SAW} struck it and said: "Be firm, O Uhud! For upon you there are no more than a Prophet, a Siddiq, and two martyrs. (Reported by al-Bukhari)
- Hz Umar ^{RA} had a deep inner feeling his end was near after a lifetime of justice and sacrifice. He made a famous du'a recorded in Bukhari: "O Allah, grant me martyrdom in Your Cause, and let my death be in the city of Your Messenger"
- In 23 AH, he performed his final Hajj and supplicated at Al-Abtah: "O Allah, my strength has waned... take my life before I fall short of my duty"
- Upon returning to Madinah, he addressed the people: "I have established the Prophet's Sunnah and left you on a clear-cut track" , and before Dhul-Hijjah ended, he was killed
- He also saw a prophetic dream of a rooster pecking him twice; 'Asmaa' Bint 'Umays interpreted it as a non-Arab man who would kill him

Death of Hz Umar ^{RA}

- The conspiracy was led by Abu Lo'lo'ah al-Majusi (a Persian slave of Al-Mugheerah), filled with hatred for Islam and the Arabs
- He was aided by Al-Hurmuthaan (captured king of Al-Ahwaaz) and Jufaynah, a Christian, making it a coordinated plot
- On the morning of the attack, Abu Lo'lo'ah entered the mosque with a double-edged dagger, stabbed 'Umar six times, and wounded 13 others (7 fatally) before killing himself
- Despite being fatally wounded, Hz Umar's first concern was completing the Fajr prayer, he asked Hz Abdur-Rahmaan bin Awf ^{RA} to lead it
- When told his killer was a non-Muslim, Hz Umar ^{RA} said: "Praise be to Allah Who did not cause me to die at the hand of a man who claims to be Muslim"
- Hz Umar^{RA} settled his debts, gave final counsel, and humbly asked to be buried beside the Prophet ^{SAW} and Abu Bakr, Hz Aishah ^{RA} granted permission
- When praised for his rule, he said: "I wish these would merely counterbalance my shortcomings, so that I neither lose nor gain"

Death of Hz Umer ^{RA}

Ibn 'Umar said: "'Umar's head was resting on my lap. So he said: 'Place my cheek on the ground.' So I did. He then said: 'Woe unto me and woe unto my mother if Allah does not have mercy on me.'" (Reported by Adh-Dhahabi.)

His dying request to his son, 'Abdullaah was: "Be economic when shrouding me, for if I have earned myself Allah's good reward, He will grant me what is far better than it, and if not, He will immediately take it away from me. Be economic when digging my grave, for if I have earned myself Allah's good reward, He will then expand it for me for as far as my eyes can see, and if not, He will shrink it till my ribs are squeezed. No woman is to attend my funeral. Do not praise me for what is not in me, for Allah knows best all about me. Hurry as you carry me to my grave, for if I have earned myself Allah's good reward, you will have brought me to what is far better for me, and if not, you will have taken off your shoulders an evil you were carrying." (Reported by Ibn Sa'd.)